FREE · PRINT AT HOME OR SCHOOL

DETECTIVE STARTER KIT

Everything a new Conkerbury Detective needs





PRIYA: "Every detective starts somewhere. We started with a notebook, a magnifying glass and a sausage dog in a deerstalker. You can start with this kit!"

IN THIS KIT

1. **ID card**: your official detective ID (name only)
2. **Case notebook**: a page to fill in for any case
3. **Elimination grid**: the detectives' favourite tool
4. **Cipher wheel**: make it, then crack three secret messages
5. **Fingerprint file**: take your own prints and solve the Custard Cream case
6. **Memory test**: how much can you remember in one minute?
7. **Spot the difference**: six things have changed on the desk
8. **Answers**: for checking at the very end

YOU WILL NEED

A pencil, scissors, a glue stick, a paper fastener (split pin) for the cipher wheel, and some sticky tape for fingerprints. A grown-up should help with the scissors and the split pin. Print the cipher wheel pages on thin card if you can.

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CUT OUT AND KEEP

YOUR DETECTIVE ID CARD

One for you and one for a detective friend

Draw your detective face

OFFICIAL ID CARD

CONKERBURY DETECTIVE

Detective name

_____



My detective skill (tick one)

- ☐ **The Brains** · writes down every clue
- ☐ **The Legs** · gets the statements
- ☐ **The Measurer** · measures everything
- ☐ **The Lookout** · draws maps, spots patterns
- ☐ **The Nose** · sniffs out the missing thing

My thumbprint

THE DETECTIVE'S PROMISE

I will look carefully, listen to everyone and write everything down. I will never guess: every answer needs a clue. And I will always share the biscuits (except with Biscuit).

Signed

_____

Badge number CD-____

✂ Cut round the dashed line, fold along the dotted line, and glue the two halves back to back.

Draw your detective face

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Detective safety rule: real detectives keep secrets safe. Only write your detective name on your card: never your address, school, phone number or a photo.

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PHOTOCOPY ME AS MANY TIMES AS YOU LIKE

CASE NOTEBOOK

Case name: _____ **Date:** _____

What is missing? _____

SUSPECTS

Suspect	Where were they? What did they say?	Still in?

CLUES I FOUND

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

EVIDENCE SKETCH

CASE CLOSED!

Who did it? _____

Where / how? _____

How I know (which clues ruled everyone else out):

_____

_____

_____

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THE DETECTIVES' FAVOURITE TOOL

ELIMINATION GRID



PRIYA: "Write the suspects down the side and the clues along the top. Each time a clue rules someone out, put a cross. When only one person has no crosses at all, you've got them!"

Suspect	Clue ____	Clue ____	Clue ____	Clue ____	Clue ____	Clue ____	Clue ____	Still in?

HOW TO USE IT

1. Write a suspect's name in each row. 2. Write a short name for each clue at the top (for example "muddy shoes"). 3. Check every suspect against every clue: ✗ if the clue rules them out, ✓ if it fits. 4. Only one suspect should be left with no ✗. If two are left, there is a clue you haven't used yet!

PRACTICE: WHO ATE THE CAKE?

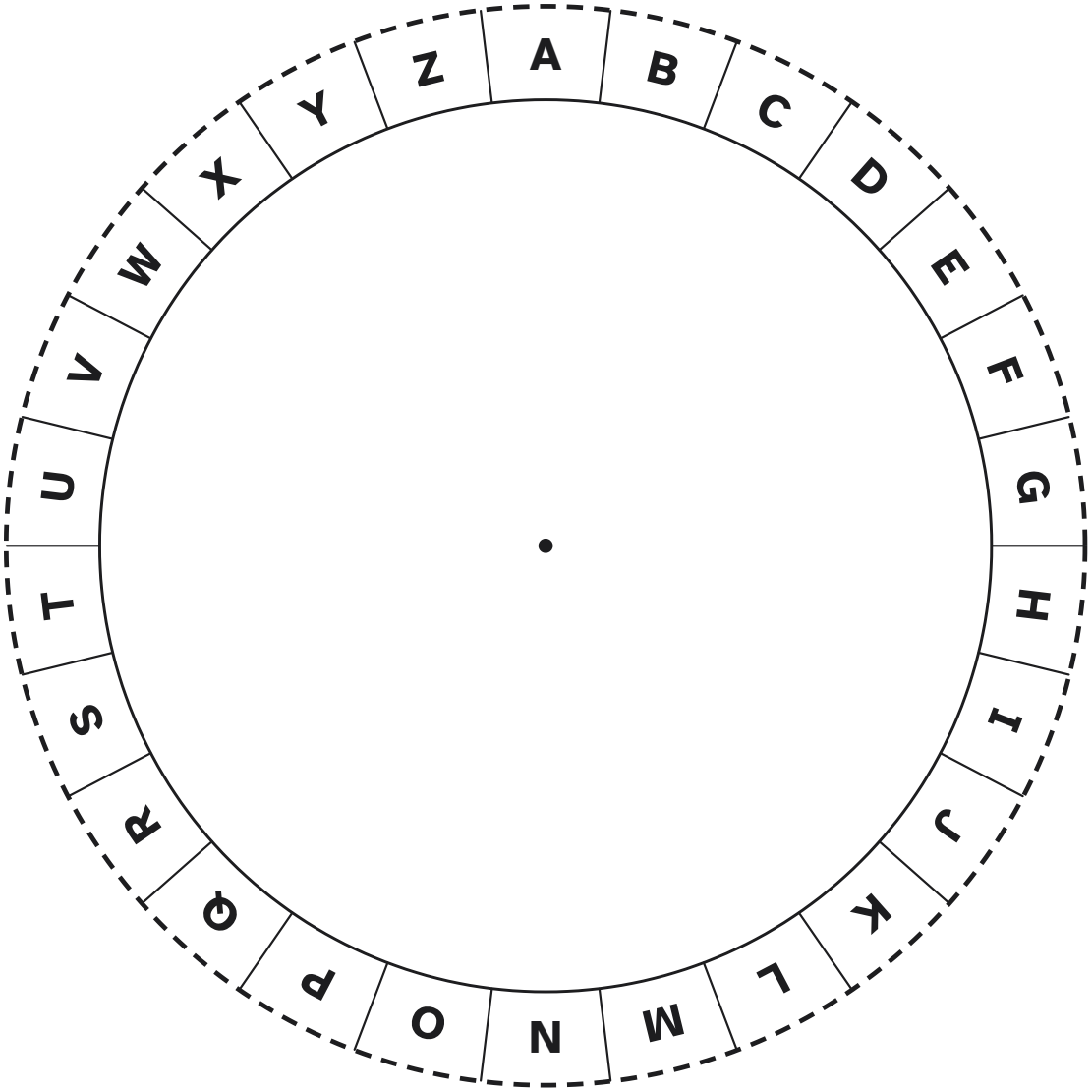
Biscuit, Ollie and Ffion were all in the kitchen. **Clue 1:** the cake-eater had crumbs on their nose. Biscuit and Ollie both did. **Clue 2:** the cake-eater has four legs. Put the three names in the grid and try it!

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MAKE IT: PART 1

CIPHER WHEEL: OUTER WHEEL

The outer ring holds the CODE letters



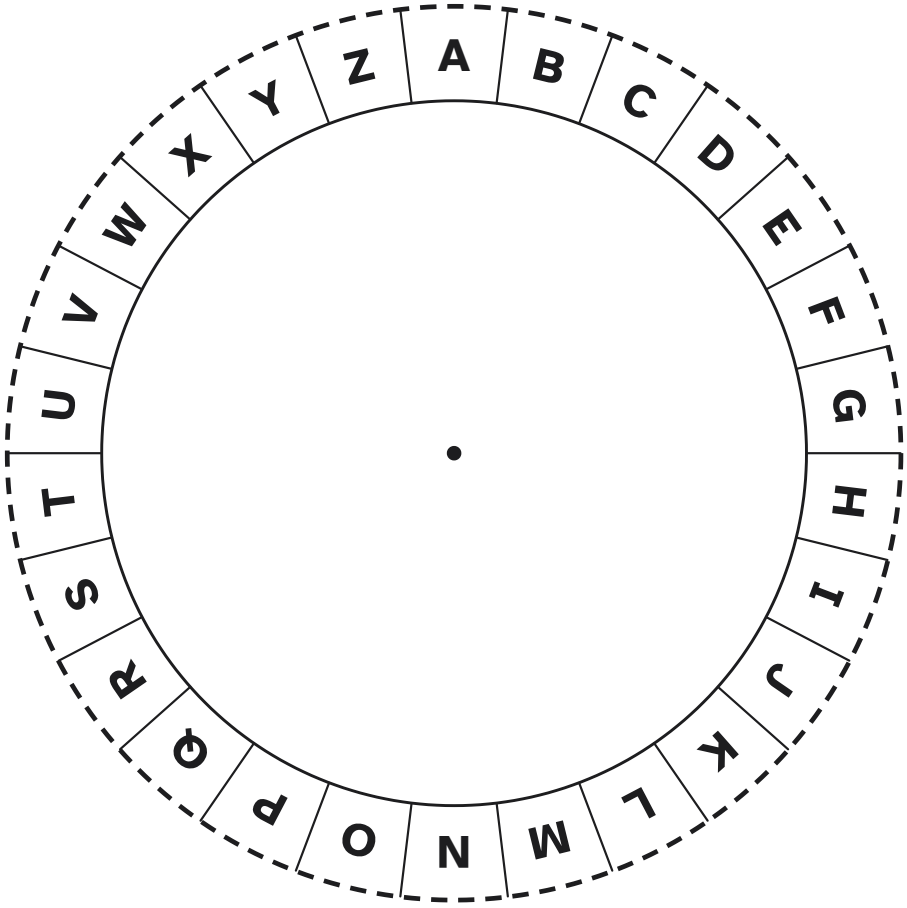
Cut out the big circle along the dashed line. Glue it onto thin card first if you can, so it lasts longer. Ask a grown-up to make a small hole in the very centre dot.

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MAKE IT: PART 2

CIPHER WHEEL: INNER WHEEL

The inner ring holds the REAL letters



PUT IT TOGETHER

1. Cut out this smaller circle. 2. Ask a grown-up to make a hole in the centre dot. 3. Lay the small wheel on top of the big wheel and push a paper fastener (split pin) through both holes. Open the legs at the back. 4. Now the small wheel can turn, and its letters sit just inside the big wheel's letters.

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USE YOUR WHEEL

SECRET MESSAGE DECODER

HOW TO DECODE

Each message has a **key**, like **A=D**. Turn the inner wheel until its **A** sits under the **D** on the outer wheel. Then find each code letter on the **OUTER** ring and write down the letter just **inside** it on the inner ring.



OLLIE: "Try the first one with me. Key A=D. The first code letter is P. Find P on the outside, look just inside it and you get... M! Keep going!"

1 MESSAGE 1

KEY: A=D

P H H W P H D W W K H F R Q N H U W U H H D W

I R X U

2 MESSAGE 2

KEY: A=K

L S C M E S D R K C O K D O X D R O O F S N O X M O

K Q K S X

3 MESSAGE 3

KEY: A=R

K Y V S V J K U V K V T K Z M V J E V M V I X Z M V

L G

SEND YOUR OWN

Choose a key, turn your wheel, then find each letter of your message on the **inner** ring and write the outer letter instead. Give your friend the code and the key!

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DETECTIVE SKILL

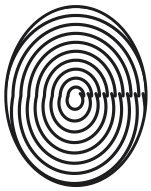
THE FINGERPRINT FILE

Everybody's fingerprints are different, even twins'. Detectives sort prints into three main shapes:



LOOP

lines come in, turn round like a hairpin and go back



WHORL

lines go round and round, like a snail shell



ARCH

lines go up and over, like a hill

TAKE YOUR OWN PRINTS

1. Scribble hard with a soft pencil on scrap paper until you have a dark patch. 2. Rub one fingertip on it. 3. Press a piece of clear sticky tape on your fingertip, peel it off and stick it in a box. Which shape is each of yours?

Thumb	Pointer	Middle	Ring	Little

FINGERPRINT FACTS

Your fingerprints were already formed before you were born, and they stay the same pattern all your life. Small cuts can leave a **scar line** across a print, which makes it even easier to identify. Koalas have fingerprints that look a lot like ours!

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ROOKIE CASE · ONE TO SOLVE

THE CASE OF THE CUSTARD CREAM FINGERPRINT

A Starter Kit case

Someone has been dipping into the custard cream tin at the Conkerbury Detectives' meeting. They left a fingerprint on the shiny lid. Priya dusted it with cocoa powder (a real detective trick!) and Alfie drew it carefully. Now compare it with everybody's prints.

THE PRINT ON THE LID

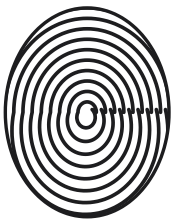




A Priya



B Ollie



C Ffion



D Alfie



E Mrs Doyle



F Biscuit

YOUR MISSION

Look at the **shape** of each print first. Then look for a **scar line**. Only one print matches the lid exactly. Whose is it?

THE CUSTARD CREAM THIEF IS...

Answer: Ollie. His print is the only whorl with a scar line across it.



FFION: "Top tip: hold the page at arm's length first and just look at the shapes. Then get close with a magnifying glass for the tiny details."

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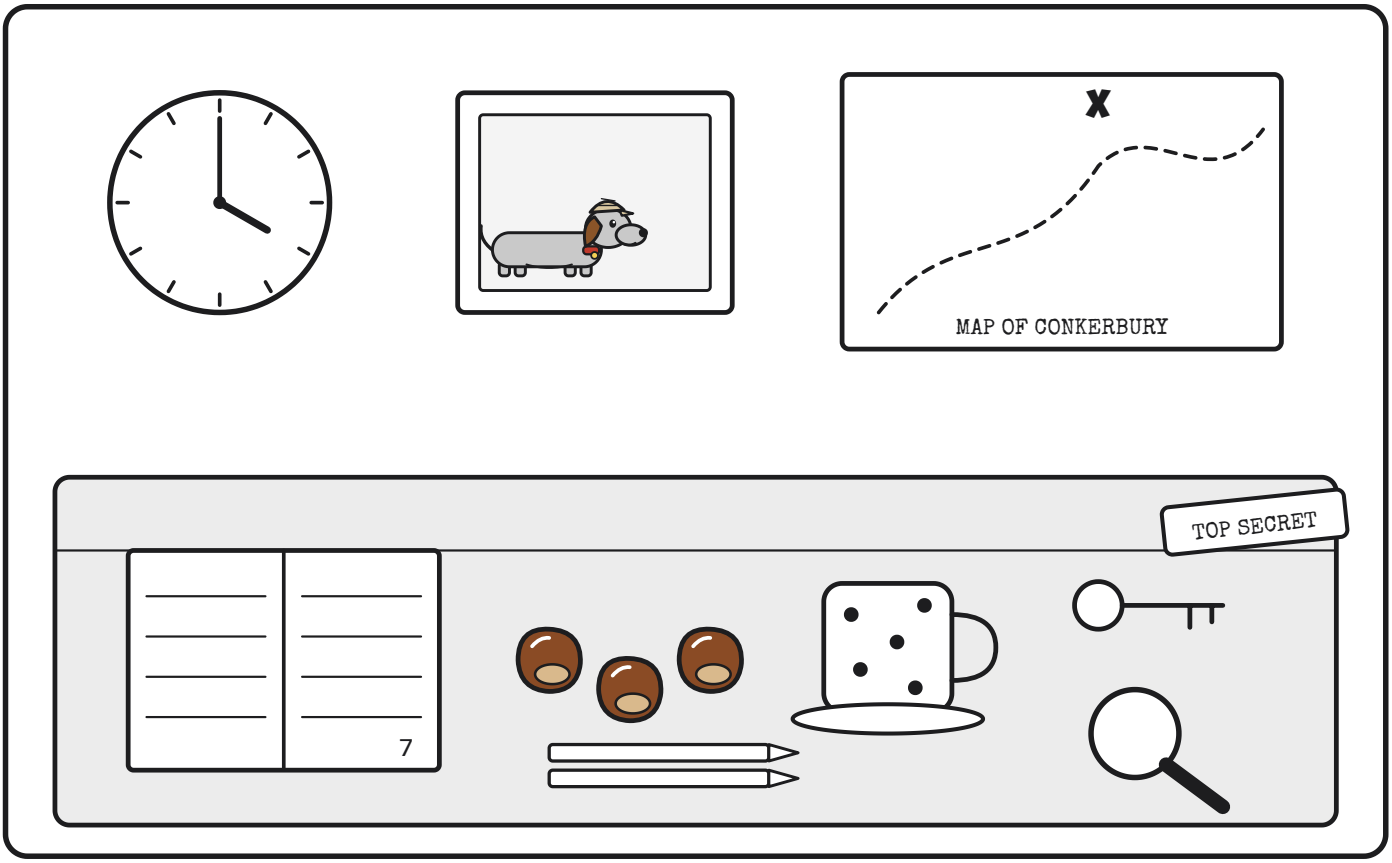
DETECTIVE SKILL

THE ONE-MINUTE MEMORY TEST

Detectives notice EVERYTHING

HOW TO PLAY

Look at the detectives' desk for **one minute** (ask someone to time you). Try to remember everything you can see. Then turn the page over and answer the questions without peeking!





ALFIE: "My trick: say what you see out loud, in order, left to right. Clock, photo, map… then the desk. It sticks in your head much better."

Make it harder: only look for 30 seconds. **Play with a friend:** take turns asking each other the questions and keep score.

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NO PEEKING AT THE LAST PAGE!

MEMORY TEST: QUESTIONS

1. What time did the clock say? _____
2. How many conkers were on the desk? _____
3. Whose photo was on the wall? _____
4. What was printed on the stamp? _____
5. What was the pattern on the teacup? _____
6. How many pencils were on the desk? _____
7. What page was the notebook open at? _____
8. Which letter was on the map? _____

YOUR SCORE

Turn back and check. **0 to 3:** Rookie. **4 to 6:** Junior Detective. **7 or 8:** Inspector! Biscuit scored 1. He only remembered the photo of himself.

Answers: 1. 4 o'clock · 2. 3 · 3. Biscuit's · 4. TOP SECRET · 5. Spots · 6. 2 · 7. 7 · 8. X

MAKE YOUR OWN MEMORY TEST

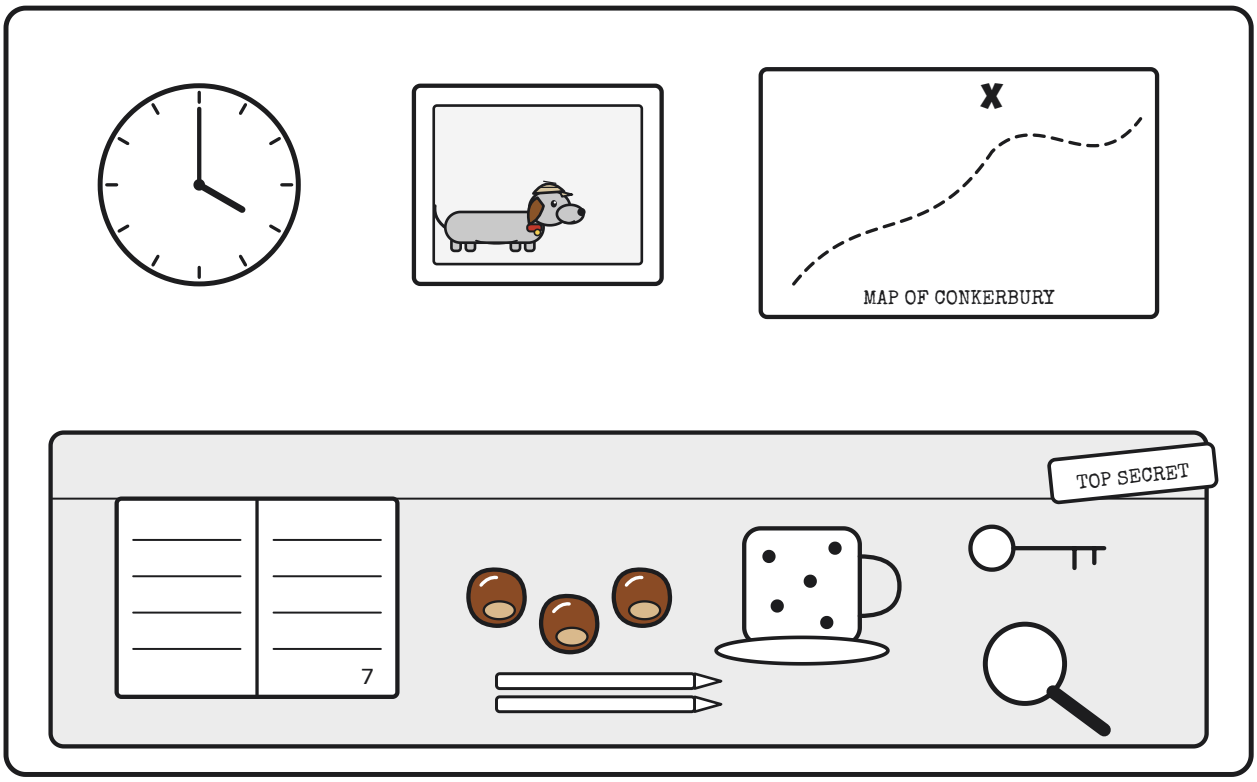
Put 10 small things on a tray (a spoon, a sock, a conker…). Let a friend look for one minute, then cover it with a tea towel. How many can they remember? Now secretly take one thing away. Can they spot what's missing?

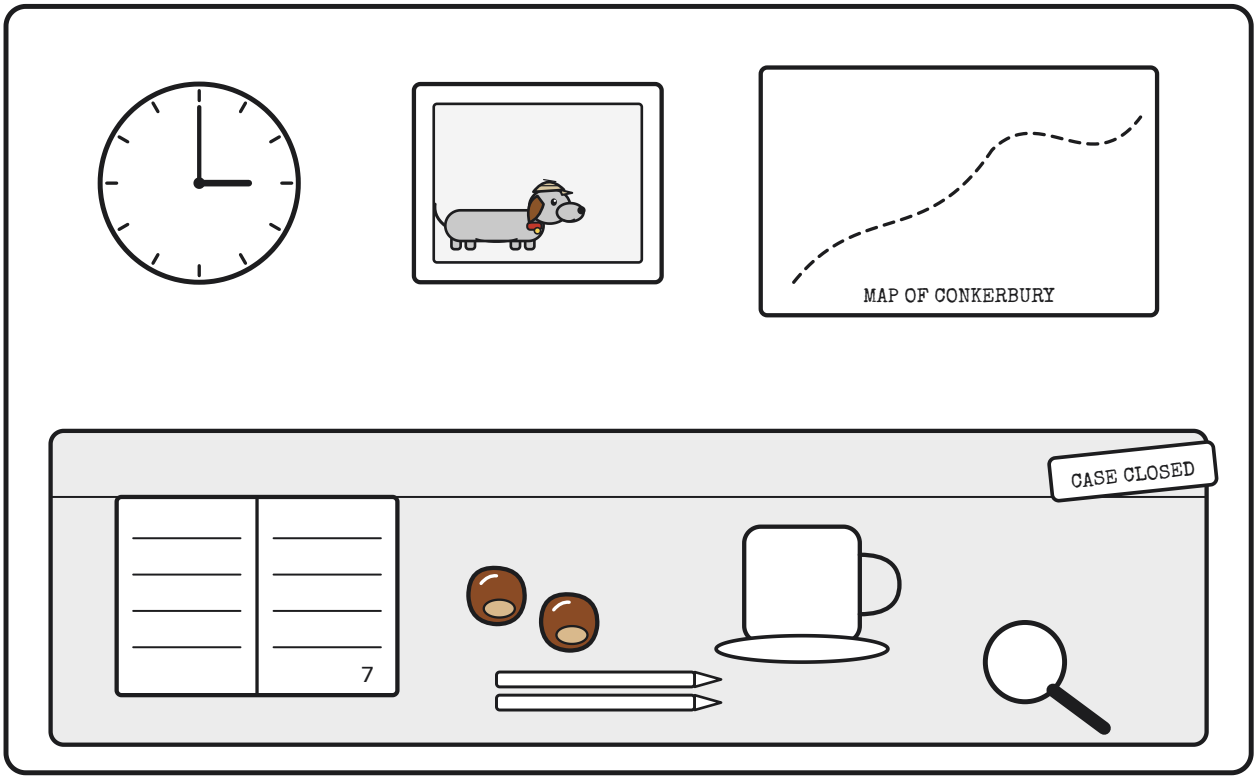
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DETECTIVE SKILL

SPOT THE SIX DIFFERENCES

Someone has been tidying the desk...





Circle the six things that are different in the bottom picture. Then tick one off each time: ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

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FOR THE VERY END

ANSWERS

SECRET MESSAGES

- **Message 1** (A=D): MEET ME AT THE CONKER TREE AT FOUR
- **Message 2** (A=K): BISCUIT HAS EATEN THE EVIDENCE AGAIN
- **Message 3** (A=R): THE BEST DETECTIVES NEVER GIVE UP

Each message has been checked by computer: only its own key turns it into real words.

THE CUSTARD CREAM FINGERPRINT

Ollie. Only two prints are whorls, like the one on the lid: Ollie's and Ffion's. Ffion's has no scar line, so it must be Ollie. (He says he was "testing them for freshness".)

MEMORY TEST

1. 4 o'clock · 2. 3 · 3. Biscuit's · 4. TOP SECRET · 5. Spots · 6. 2 · 7. 7 · 8. X

SPOT THE DIFFERENCE

1. The clock says 3 o'clock instead of 4 o'clock.
2. There are only 2 conkers instead of 3.
3. The X has gone from the map.
4. The teacup has lost its spots.
5. The key has disappeared.
6. The stamp says CASE CLOSED instead of TOP SECRET.

PRACTICE GRID: WHO ATE THE CAKE?

Biscuit. Clue 1 rules out Ffion (no crumbs). Clue 2 rules out Ollie (two legs). Only Biscuit has no crosses. Obviously.

FOR GROWN-UPS

All free, no sign-up and no email needed. There is a free taster case and more printables at **conkerburydetectives.co.uk/printables.html**. The full book, **The Case of the Missing Conker Champion**, has 30 cases: **https://www.amazon.co.uk/dp/B0HQ1LMJGX**.

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